

City University of Hong Kong

Information on a Course offered by Department of Accountancy with effect from Semester B in 2014 / 2015

Part I

Course Title: Advanced Taxation

Course Code: AC4351

Course Duration: 1 semester

Credit Units: 3

Level: B4

Medium of Instruction: English

Prerequisites: AC4251 Taxation & Tax Planning

Precursors: Nil

Equivalent Courses: Nil

Exclusive Courses: Nil

Part II

Course Aims

This course aims to:

1. enable students to consolidate tax knowledge obtained from the prerequisite course – AC4251 Taxation & Tax Planning, especially with regard to taxes on income and profits, and the tax administration of Hong Kong;
2. provide students with knowledge of the key concepts of taxation of international transactions, special types of taxpayers, field audit and investigation, anti-tax avoidance, tax management and stamp duty;
3. further enhance students' analytical ability to solve technical tax problems in a systematic way;
4. develop students' practical taxation skills to provide competent tax advice for professional firms and business organizations;
5. extend students' communication skills for the effective dissemination of taxation-related information both in written and verbal forms;

6. prepare students so that they can demonstrate generic skills in interpersonal interaction, working individually and in team situations;
7. reinforce students' ethical outlook and sense of professional integrity when dealing with tax-related issues for business clients.

Course Intended Learning Outcomes (CILOs)

Upon successful completion of this course, students should be able to:

No.	CILOs	Weighting (if applicable) (1 = most important, 2 = secondary importance, 3 = least important)	DEC-related dimension
1.	ANALYZE the taxation issues and planning opportunities in both local and international business operations and RECOGNIZE the risk involved through INTERPRETATION of the law and CONDUCT research in academic and professional taxation literature.	1	Attitude, Ability
2.	APPLY the law and practice of Hong Kong income tax to special business operations.	1	Attitude, Ability
3.	DEMONSTRATE the law and practice of field audit and investigation, tax evasion and penalty.	1	Attitude, Ability
4.	IDENTIFY and EVALUATE the major contemporary issues in Hong Kong taxation.	2	Attitude, Ability
5.	OPERATE effectively as a tax professional, demonstrating team building, and communication skills.	2	Attitude, Ability, Accomplishment

Teaching and Learning Activities (TLAs)

(Indicative of likely activities and tasks designed to facilitate students' achievement of the CILOs. Final details will be provided to students in their first week of attendance in this course)

CILO No.	TLAs	Hours/semester (if applicable)
CILO 1 CILO 2 CILO 3 CILO 4	TLA1: <u>Brief lectures</u> will illustrate and explain important concepts. The discussion shall be supplemented by examples, both hypothetical and real life situational. TLA2: <u>In-class learning activities</u> are problems designed and used for illustration purposes. Students are encouraged to solve these problems. Lecturer will provide guidance to students in problem solving.	TLA1: 1.5-2.0 hours per WEEK TLA2: 1.0-1.5 hours per week

CILO 1 CILO 4 CILO 5	TLA3: Debate: Students will form groups which will stand on behalf of either the taxpayer or the Revenue and to present their arguments in class through the analysis and evaluation of the assigned real-life tax case. *	TLA3: 11 to 13 hours per week
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*DEC TLA element

Assessment Tasks/Activities

(Indicative of likely activities and tasks designed to assess how well the students achieve the CILOs. Final details will be provided to students in their first week of attendance in this course)

CILO No.	Type of Assessment Tasks/Activities	Weighting (if applicable)	Remarks
CILO 1	AT1, AT2, AT3, AT4, AT5		
CILO 2	AT1, AT2, AT5		
CILO 3	AT1, AT2, AT5		
CILO 4	AT1, AT2, AT3, AT4, AT5		
CILO 5	AT3, AT4, AT5		

Examination: 50% (a 3-hour examination)

AT1 Final Examination (50%): A written comprehensive examination to assess students' competence level of the topics.

Coursework: 50%

AT2 Tests (20-25%): A 3-hour test to provide a mid-semester assessment of students' competence level of the topics.

AT3 Class Debate (10-15%): Students will present and argue a case in teams during class. Performance will be assessed based on the capability to identify the issue, the quality of the research conducted and the skills in presentation in the class. *

AT4 Contribution to Class Debate (5-10%): During the class debate, other students will ask questions to evaluate the performance of the debating teams. They are required to summarize the debate in a short report. Assessment will be based on the report submitted. *

AT5 Class Participation (5%): Students will attempt short problems in small groups during class, and demonstrate the solutions to problems. They may also be asked to give answers to the questions raised by course lecturer. Class participation will be assessed based on student effort rather than correctness.

Students are required to pass both coursework and examination components in order to pass the course.

* DEC AT element

Grading of Student Achievement: Also refer to Grading of Courses in the Academic Regulations.

CILO No.	Excellent (A+, A, A-)	Good (B+, B, B-)	Adequate (C+, C, C-)	Marginal (D)
CILO 1	Demonstrate an excellent understanding in the identification and analysis of taxation issues, planning opportunities and associated risk in both local and international business operations through technical research	Demonstrate a good understanding in the identification and analysis of taxation issues, planning opportunities and associated risk in both local and international business operations through technical research	Demonstrate an adequate understanding in the identification and analysis of taxation issues, planning opportunities and associated risk in both local and international business operations through technical research	Demonstrate a basic understanding in the identification and analysis of taxation issues, planning opportunities and associated risk in both local and international business operations through technical research
CILO 2	Demonstrate an excellent understanding and application of the law and principles of the taxation of clubs and associations, financial institutions, ship and aircraft owners, partnerships and insurance companies.	Demonstrate a good understanding and application of the law and principles of the taxation of clubs and associations, financial institutions, ship and aircraft owners, partnerships and insurance companies.	Demonstrate an adequate understanding and application of the law and principles of the taxation of clubs and associations, financial institutions, ship and aircraft owners, partnerships and insurance companies.	Demonstrate a basic understanding and application of the law and principles of the taxation of clubs and associations, financial institutions, ship and aircraft owners, partnerships and insurance companies.
CILO 3	Demonstrate an excellent understanding of the law and practice of field audit and investigation, tax evasion and penalty	Demonstrate a good understanding of the law and practice of field audit and investigation, tax evasion and penalty	Demonstrate an adequate understanding of the law and practice of field audit and investigation, tax evasion and penalty	Demonstrate basic understanding of the law and practice of field audit and investigation, tax evasion and penalty
CILO 4	Demonstrate an excellent understanding of the taxation issues in government fiscal policy	Demonstrate a good understanding of the taxation issues in government fiscal policy	Demonstrate an adequate understanding of the taxation issues in government fiscal policy	Demonstrate basic understanding of the taxation issues in government fiscal policy

CILO No.	Excellent (A+, A, A-)	Good (B+, B, B-)	Adequate (C+, C, C-)	Marginal (D)
CILO5	Demonstrate excellent teamwork and communication skills in the class debate	Demonstrate good teamwork and communication skills in the class debate	Demonstrate adequate teamwork and communication skills in the class debate	Demonstrate basic teamwork and communication skills in the class debate

Part III

Keyword Syllabus

Hong Kong tax, Property tax, Salaries Tax, Profits Tax, Depreciation allowances, Personal assessment, Returns and information, Assessments of tax, Tax administration, Tax planning, Anti-tax avoidance, Tax evasion, Tax investigation, Clubs and Associations, Financial Institutions, Ship and Aircraft Owners, Partnerships and Insurance Companies, Stamp Duty.

Recommended Reading Text(s)

1. Ho, Patrick K.W. Hong Kong Taxation and Tax Planning. Latest edition. Pilot Publishing Company Ltd.
2. Lee, D., Ho, C.M. Advanced Taxation in Hong Kong. Latest edition. Longman Hong Kong Education.
3. Smith, D.G., Ayesha, Lau. Hong Kong Taxation: Law & Practice. Latest edition. The Chinese University Press.

Online Resources

1. Canvas site of the course
2. Inland Revenue Department website, Hong Kong SAR: <http://www.ird.gov.hk>
3. Bilingual Laws Information System: <http://www.legislation.gov.hk/eng/home.htm>